



THE KENYA CONSUMER PRICE INDEX AND INFLATION REPORT

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Overview

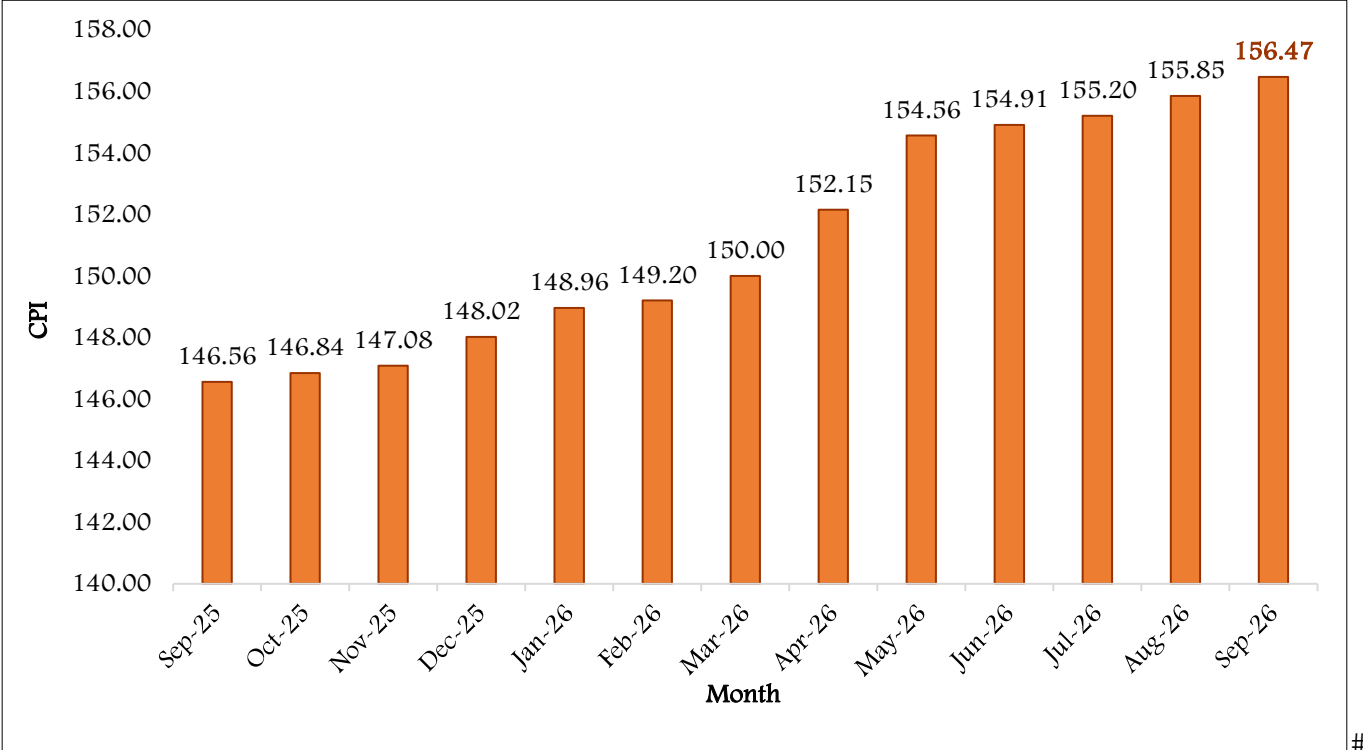
Annual consumer price inflation was 6.8 per cent in September 2026, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI).[#] This implies that the general price level was 6.8 per cent higher in September 2026 than it was in September 2025. The price increase was primarily driven by a rise in prices of items in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (9.5%); Transport (15.6%), and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (3.2%) over the one-year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) is defined as a measure of the weighted aggregate change over time in retail prices paid by consumers for a given basket of goods and services. The CPI measures the cost of purchasing this fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period, which for the current CPI is February 2019. Inflation rate is defined as a percentage change of the CPI between two periods. There are different inflation rates that can be computed, such as annual (year-on-year), quarterly (quarter-to-quarter) and monthly (month-on-month) inflation rates. Data used to derive the inflation rates is collected through a monthly survey of retail prices from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide. The survey is conducted during the second and third weeks of the month.

The Overall CPI and Inflation Trends, September 2025 – September 2026

As presented in Figure 1, the overall index increased from 155.85 in August 2026 to 156.47 in September 2026, resulting in a monthly inflation rate of 0.4 per cent. The year-on-year inflation stood at 6.8 per cent in September 2026 as shown in Figure 2.

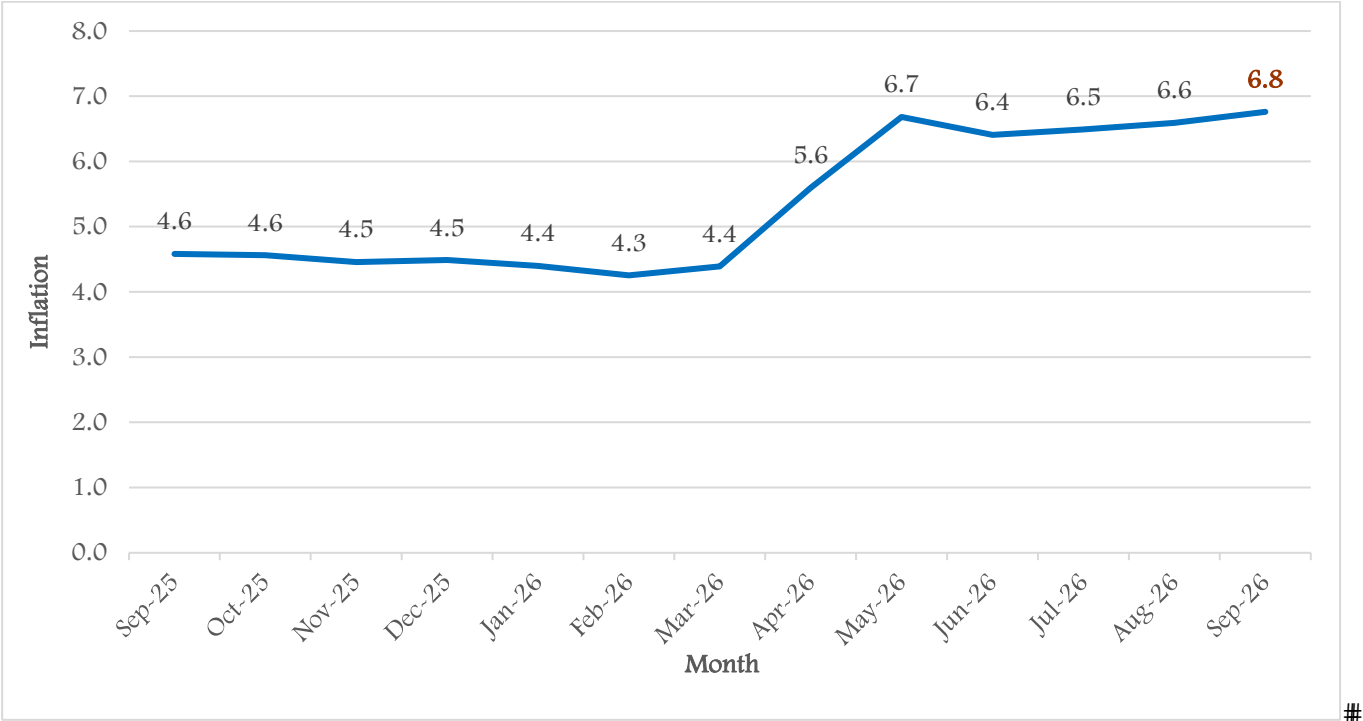
Figure 1: Overall CPI, September 2025 – September 2026



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Figure 2: Inflation Trends, September 2025 – September 2026



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Table 1: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

13 COICOP Divisions	Weight %	% Change on last month (September 2026 / August 2026)	% Change on same month of the previous year (September 2026 / September 2025)
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	0.9	9.5
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.4	2.8
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.1	2.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	0.1	3.2
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.2	3.1
Health	2.9116	0.1	2.8
Transport	9.6468	-0.4	15.6
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.1	0.8
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	0.1	3.5
Education Services	5.5620	0.1	3.0
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.1	3.0
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.0	1.1
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.2	2.5
Total	100.0000	0.4	6.8

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Figure 3: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, August 2026 – September 2026

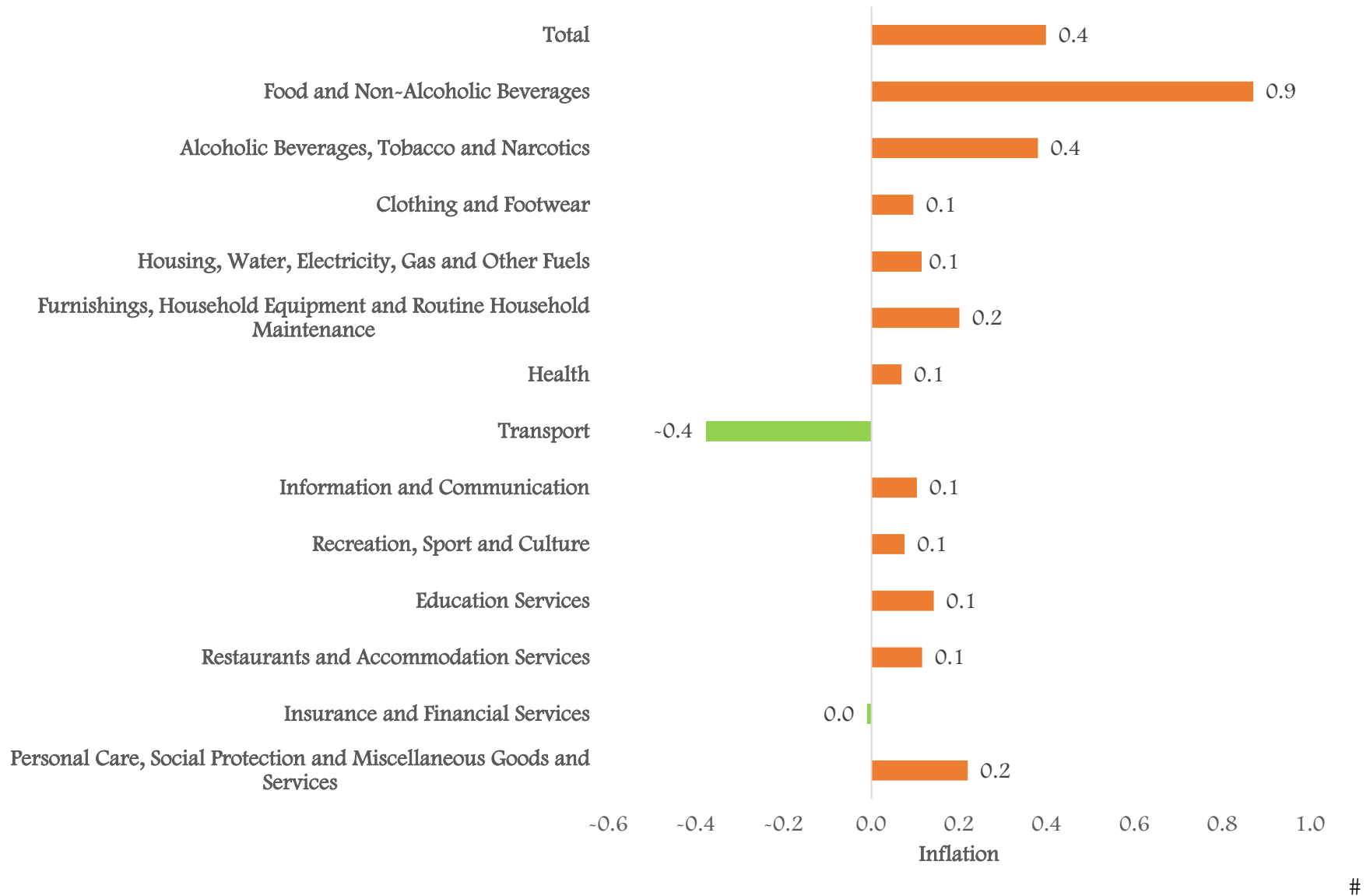
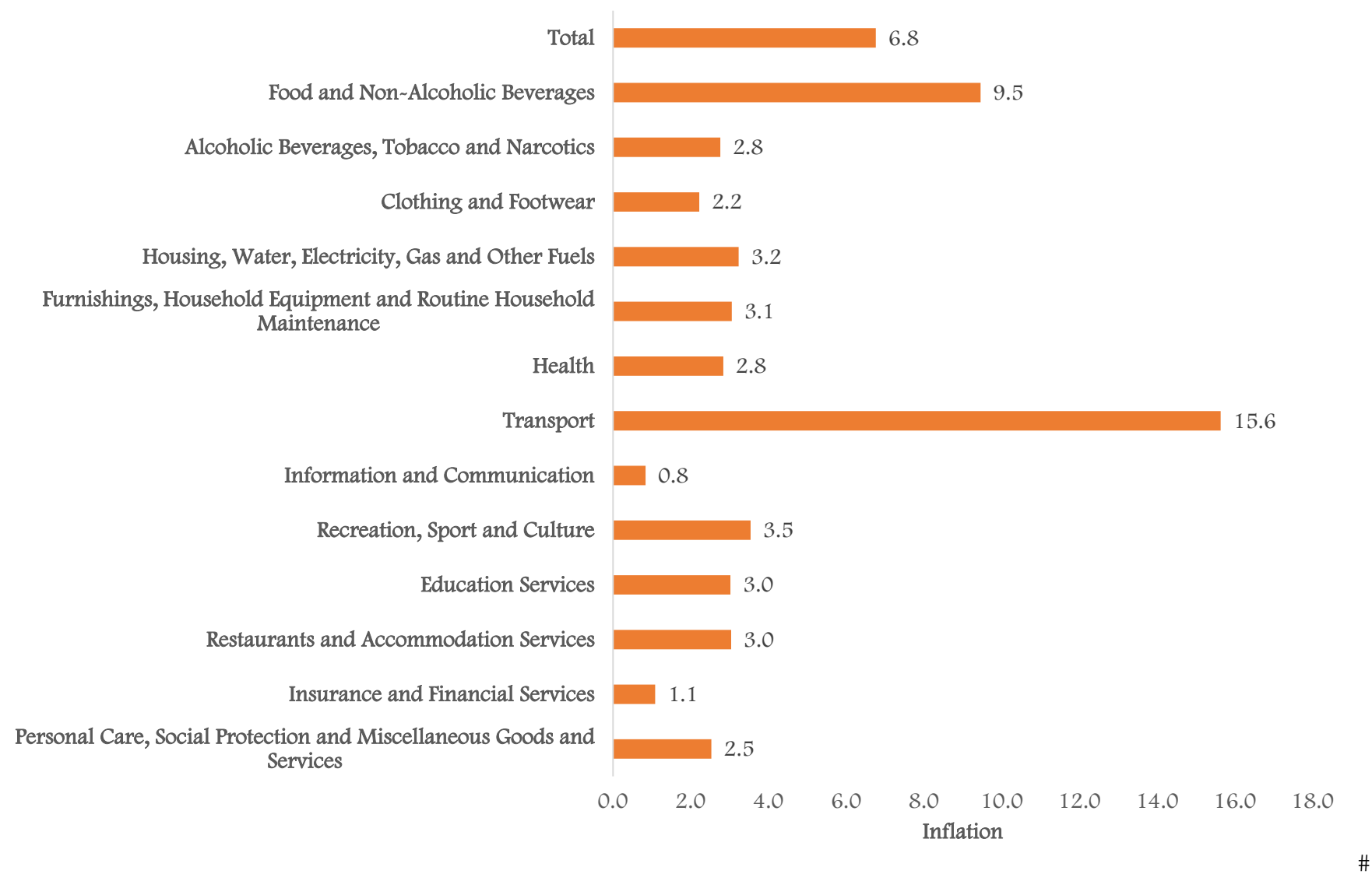


Figure 4: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, September 2025 – September 2026



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Table 2: Key Drivers of Inflation for each of the 13 Divisions

Monthly		Yearly
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages		
 0.9%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, the price of white wheat flour increased by 4.5 per cent, that of fresh unpacked cow milk/ fresh cream rose by 5.8 per cent, and that for fresh packeted cow milk recorded an increase of 6.0 per cent over the same period. In contrast, tomatoes recorded a price decline of 4.1 per cent, followed by loose maize flour, which fell by 1.9 per cent, and sugar, which declined by 0.4 per cent.	 9.5% Over the twelve months to September 2026, inflation in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages division increased to 9.5 per cent.
Transport		
 -0.4%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, transport fares declined while air travel costs rose sharply. Country bus/ matatu fares for inter-town travel fell by 1.0 per cent and city bus/ matatu fares within towns and their environs eased by 0.3 per cent. International flights, however, moved in the opposite direction, recording a notable price increase of 8.1% over the same period..	 15.6% Over the twelve months to September 2026, prices of items under Transport division went up by 15.6 per cent.
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels		
 0.1%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, firewood prices rose by 1.8 per cent and charcoal prices increased by 1.6 per cent. However, electricity (200 kWh) prices fell by 2.2 per cent, while Gas/ LPG prices declined by 0.2 per cent, over the same period.	 3.2 % Over the twelve months to September 2026, the general price level of items under the division rose by 3.2 per cent.
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics		
 0.4%	Cigarette prices rose by 0.2 per cent, while beer (lagers, stouts) recorded an increase of 0.1 per cent.	 2.8% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the prices under Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics division rose by 2.8 per cent.
Clothing and Footwear		
 0.1%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, boys' school uniform prices declined by 0.1 per cent, while men's shirt prices rose by 0.2 per cent. Women's trousers recorded the largest increase in this group, rising by 0.9 per cent over the same period.	 2.2% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the prices of items under Clothing and Footwear division increased by 2.2 per cent.
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance		
 0.2%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, both detergents and laundry soap/ bar soap recorded identical price increases of 0.5 per cent.	 3.1% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance division inflation rose to 3.1 per cent.
Health		
 0.1%	Between September 2026 and August 2026, prices for medicines for cholesterol and blood pressure declined by 0.1 per cent, while dewormers recorded the largest increase in this group at 0.8 per cent. Antibiotic prices also rose, but by a smaller margin of 0.2 per cent, over the same period.	 2.8% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the prices of items under Health division increased by 2.8 per cent.

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Monthly		Yearly
Information and Communication		
	 0.1% Between September 2026 and August 2026, mobile handset prices (basic/ smartphone) rose by 0.3 per cent, while laptop computer prices declined by 0.1 per cent.	 0.8% The Information and Communication division recorded a yearly inflation of 0.8 per cent.
Recreation, Sport and Culture		
	 0.1% Between September 2026 and August 2026, there was an increase in prices of most items in this category. Pet foodstuff recorded the largest increase at 1.4 per cent, followed by religious books, with a price increase of 1.3 per cent. In contrast, exercise book prices declined by 0.2 per cent over the same period.	 3.5% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the Recreation, Sport and Culture division index went up by 3.5 per cent.
Education Services		
	 0.1% Between September 2026 and August 2026, private secondary tuition fees rose by 0.4 per cent, especially in international schools. On the other hand, pre-primary tuition fees declined by 0.1 per cent, over the same period.	 3.0% Over the twelve months to September 2026, prices of items under the Education division increased by 3.0 per cent.
Restaurants and Accommodation Services		
	 0.1% Between September 2026 and August 2026, hotel and restaurant beverages recorded the largest increase in this group, at 0.5 per cent, followed by hotel boarding, which rose by 0.4 per cent. Over the same period, prices for food from canteens/ kiosks declined by 0.2 per cent.	 3.0% Over the twelve months until September 2026, the index for the Restaurants and Accommodation Services division rose by 3.0 per cent.
Insurance and Financial Services		
	 0.0% Between September 2026 and August 2026, price remained the same for insurance and financial services.	 1.1% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the prices under Insurance and Financial Services division went up by 1.1 per cent.
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services		
	 0.2% Between September 2026 and August 2026, prices rose across all items in this group. Toilet paper/ tissue paper recorded the largest increase at 1.3 per cent, while both body lotion and hairdressing rose by 0.4 per cent. Barber services recorded the smallest increase in this group, at 0.3 per cent over the same period.	 2.5% Over the twelve months to September 2026, the index for the Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services division increased by 2.5 per cent.

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Movement of National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Table 3 shows movement of national average retail prices of selected commodities. Between August 2026 and September 2026, price movements for different commodities were mixed. The price of a 1 Kg unit of tomatoes fell from KSh 111.03 to KSh 106.44, while the price of 2 Kg of sifted maize flour eased from KSh 152.89 to KSh 152.00. By contrast, the price of a litre of cooking oil (salad) rose from KSh 356.72 to KSh 359.36. The most notable increase was in the price of fresh packeted cow milk, which rose from KSh 57.74 to KSh 61.23 for a 500-millilitre packet.

Electricity prices also fell over the period: the price for a 50-kWh unit dropped from KSh 1,289.47 to KSh 1,258.21 and that of the 200-kWh unit fell from KSh 5,658.80 to KSh 5,533.76.

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Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

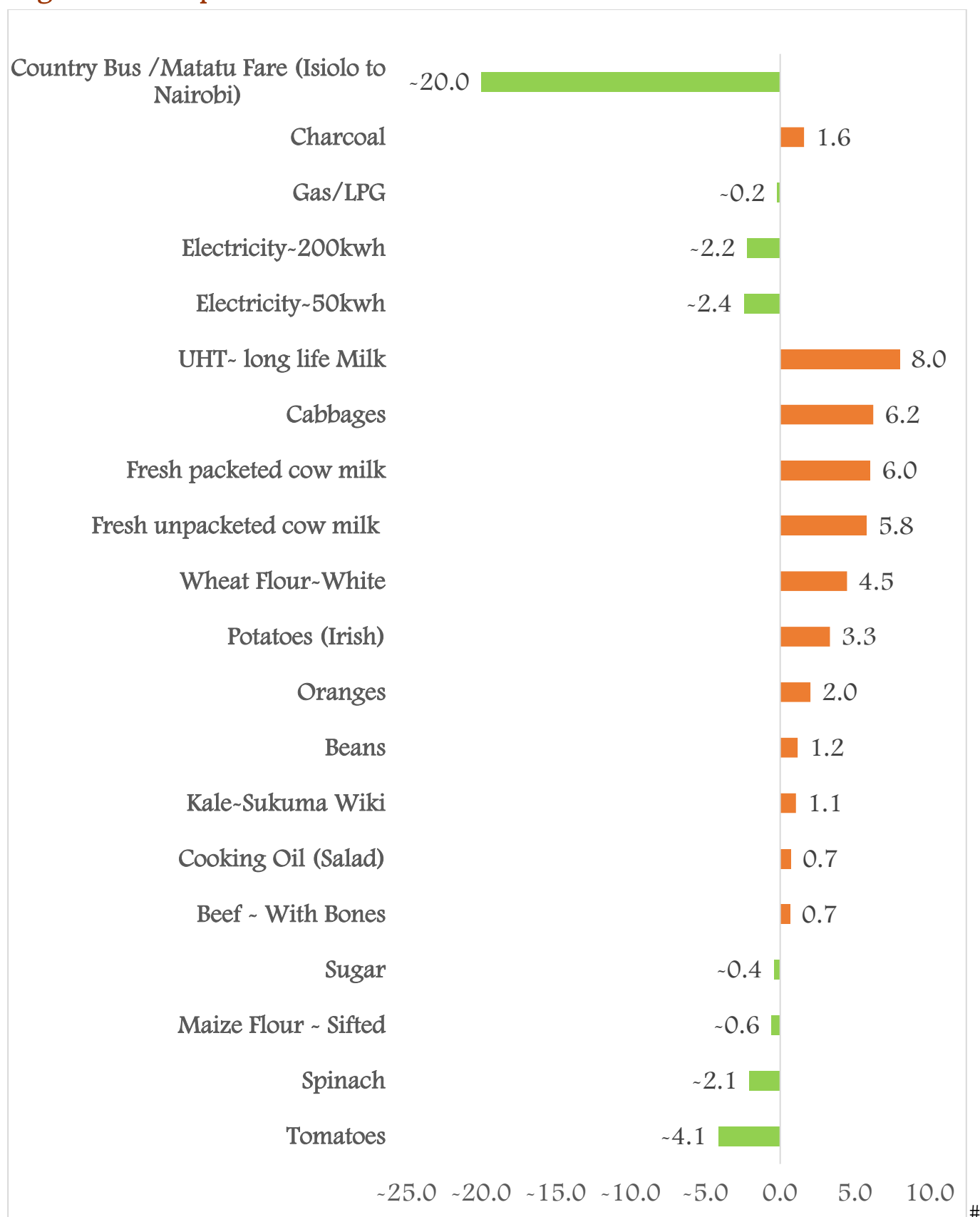
Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price September 2025	Average Price August 2026	Average Price September 2026	% Change over last September 2026/ August 2026	% Change over last year September 2026/ September 2025
Tomatoes	1	Kg	87.87	111.03	106.44	-4.1	21.1
Spinach	1	Kg	103.43	129.99	127.32	-2.1	23.1
Maize Flour - Sifted	2	Kg	152.28	152.89	152.00	-0.6	-0.2
Sugar	1	Kg	185.21	166.45	165.79	-0.4	-10.5
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	698.50	777.36	782.68	0.7	12.1
Cooking Oil (Salad)	1	Litre	342.99	356.72	359.36	0.7	4.8
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	92.48	121.21	122.49	1.1	32.5
Beans	1	Kg	182.09	180.65	182.76	1.2	0.4
Oranges	1	Kg	110.84	124.69	127.22	2.0	14.8
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	91.27	118.05	121.98	3.3	33.6
Wheat Flour-White	2	Kg	169.43	173.35	181.11	4.5	6.9
Fresh unpacketed cow milk	1	Litre	72.00	73.30	77.54	5.8	7.7
Fresh packeted cow milk	500	Millilitre	55.97	57.74	61.23	6.0	9.4
Cabbages	1	Kg	62.91	74.52	79.16	6.2	25.8
UHT- long life Milk	500	Millilitre	55.07	57.08	61.64	8.0	11.9
Electricity-50kwh	50	kWh	1,274.06	1,289.47	1,258.21	-2.4	-1.2
Electricity-200kwh	200	kWh	5,597.16	5,658.80	5,533.76	-2.2	-1.1
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,151.65	3,426.89	3,419.24	-0.2	8.5
House rent - bed sitter	1	Month	7,635.95	7,690.07	7,690.07	0.0	0.7
Kerosene/Paraffin	1	Litre	155.96	192.56	192.56	0.0	23.5
Charcoal	1	Kg	92.87	97.96	99.52	1.6	7.2
Country Bus /Matatu Fare (Isiolo to Nairobi)	1	Ticket	1,000.00	1,500.00	1,200.00	-20.0	20.0
Petrol	1	Litre	185.59	214.95	214.95	0.0	15.8
Diesel	1	Litre	172.64	219.04	219.04	0.0	26.9

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Figure 5: Percentage Change in National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities, August 2026 – September 2026



Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Core inflation is a measure of inflation that is compiled from commodities whose prices are non-volatile such as manufactured food items, health services, education services, and ICT. Core inflation increased to 4.0 per cent in September 2026, as presented in Table 4. Non-core inflation was 14.0 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Period	Core Index	Core Inflation	Non-Core Index	Non-Core Inflation
Sep-25	129.52	2.9	215.78	9.6
Oct-25	129.56	2.7	216.87	9.9
Nov-25	129.66	2.3	217.54	10.1
Dec-25	130.09	2.0	220.84	11.2
Jan-26	130.60	2.2	223.74	10.3
Feb-26	130.72	2.1	224.68	10.1
Mar-26	131.07	2.1	227.82	10.8
Apr-26	132.10	2.8	234.61	13.4
May-26	133.16	3.2	242.75	16.0
Jun-26	133.52	3.1	243.17	15.1
Jul-26	133.80	3.2	243.34	15.0
Aug-26	134.01	3.4	245.39	14.7
Sep-26	134.66	4.0	246.09	14.0

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Contribution of Core and Non-Core to the Overall Inflation

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 4.2 points, while non-core inflation contributed 2.6 points to the overall inflation in September 2026. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed to 2.8 points to the overall inflation during the same period.

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Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, September 2026

Broad Categories	Core	Non Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	1.1	1.7	2.8
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.1	~	0.1
Clothing and Footwear	0.2	~	0.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.2	0.4	0.5
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.3	~	0.3
Health	0.2	~	0.2
Transport	1.1	0.5	1.6
Information and Communication	0.1	~	0.1
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.1	~	0.1
Education Services	0.2	~	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.3	~	0.3
Insurance and Financial Services	0.1	~	0.1
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.2	~	0.2
Total	4.2	2.6	6.8

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